

07 — User Guide

This guide covers the two non-administrator user types: the **Host** (event organizer) and the **Guest** (invitee). The administrator has a separate guide in [../08-admin-guide](#).

The live site URL and sample logins are in [../10-live-link-and-credentials](#).

Part A — Host guide

1. Create an account (Features F01, F02)

1. Open the site and click **Create an account**.
2. Enter your name, email, and a password (minimum 8 characters).
3. Check your inbox for a 6-digit code and enter it to confirm. (Didn't get it? Click **Resend code**.)

2. Sign in (F03)

- Use your email and password on the **Log in** page. Forgot your password? Use **Forgot password?** to email yourself a reset code (F04).

3. Create your event (F06)

- The first time you sign in you'll be asked for the **event name, date, and location**. Click **Create event**.

4. The dashboard (F07)

The dashboard shows your event details, categories, tables, and guest list.

5. Edit or delete the event (F08, F09)

- **Edit** changes the name, date, location, or **categories** (the groups used for seating, e.g. Family / Friends / Work).
- **Delete event** removes the event and all of its guests (this cannot be undone).

6. Define tables (F10)

- Add tables and set each table's **capacity** (number of seats). Saving replaces the current table layout.

7. Add and manage guests (F11–F14)

- **Add guest:** name, email, category, and **party size** (how many people that one invitation covers).
- Click a guest to **open** their details, change their RSVP, party size, category, or **assign a table manually**, or **delete** them.

8. Generate seating (F16)

- Click **Generate seating**. SeatMe seats every guest who RSVP'd **yes**, keeping each category together where possible, and tells you if there aren't enough seats or who couldn't be placed.

9. Send invitations (F17)

- Send to **one** guest or to **everyone**. Each guest gets a personal RSVP link by email.
- **Important:** the first email a guest receives is a one-time *"Confirm subscription"* message (from Amazon SNS). They must click **Confirm** once; afterwards invitations arrive directly.

10. Share a no-login preview (F19)

- You can share `host.html?host=<your-email>` to let someone view the event **read-only** without signing in. (This is the same link the deployment prints as the demo link.) Editing requires signing in as the host or an admin.

Part B — Guest guide

1. Open your invitation (F15)

- Click the **personal link** in the invitation email. No account or password is needed.

2. RSVP

1. You'll see the event name, date, and location.
2. Choose **"I'll be there"** or **"Can't make it"**.
3. Set **how many people** are coming (your party size).
4. Optionally add a **song request**.
5. Click **Send response** — it saves instantly.

3. Check your seat

- If the host has generated seating, the RSVP page shows **your table number**. You can return to the same link anytime to update your response.

Troubleshooting

Problem	Fix
No confirmation code email	Check spam; click Resend code on the sign-up page.
Guest didn't get the invitation	Ask them to look for the SNS <i>Confirm subscription</i> email and confirm it once.
"Not enough seats" when generating	Add tables/capacity or reduce party sizes, then try again.
Numbers look like text	Expected — the API returns numbers as strings; the UI converts them automatically.